Afifah Kashif

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Research interests: AI evaluation [2,3,4,6,10], human-AI and human-robot interaction [1,5,7,9], and AI governance [4,7–9]

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge Cambridge, UK
M.Phil. Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence (with Distinction) *Oct 2025 – Jun 2026*
Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Hatice Gunes)

University of Washington, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering Seattle, USA
B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Law, Societies & Justice *Sep 2022 - Jun 2025*
Study Abroad: Rome, Italy (Jan – Mar 2024), Honors: *The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora*
GPA: 3.77/4.00, Dean's List, Completed one year early
Capstone: Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users (Instructor: Dr. Maya Cakmak)

Bellevue College Bellevue, USA
A.A. Arts and Sciences; A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences *Sep 2020 - Jun 2022*
Earned concurrently with high school through dual credit; GPA: 3.98/4.00, Dean's List

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Visiting Researcher, Stanford University Sep 2026 – Present
Prof. Julian Nyarko, Dr. Megan Ma (Legal Innovation through Frontier Technology (Lift)Lab, Stanford Law School)

Research Assistant, University of Cambridge Jul 2026 – Present
Dr. Katie Seaborn (Aspirational Computing Lab, Department of Computer Science and Technology), Dr. Malak Sadek (Human Interactions, Values & Experiences with Conversational AI (HIVE) Lab, Centre for Human Inspired AI)

Researcher, PluralisticAI Lab Mar 2026 – Present
Dr. Zhenzhen Qi (University of Connecticut), Dr. Avijit Ghosh (Hugging Face)

CORDA Democracy Fellow, Odyssean Institute Apr 2026 – Sep 2026
Jacob Haimes (Apart Research), Dr. Swaptik Chowdhury (RAND)

Research Assistant, University of Washington Sep 2024 – Jun 2025
Dr. Amy Ko (Wordplay Project, UW Information School)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Robotics Software Engineering Intern, Hello Robot May 2025 – Aug 2025
Human-Robot Interaction and UX focus (Dr. Vinitha Ranganeni)

Backend Software Engineering Intern, HowellCo Jul 2024 – Sep 2024

Software Engineering Intern, Code.org Jul 2023 – Sep 2023

Operations and Product Intern, Fiveable Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Designing Power Systems as a Social Interface for Assistive Robots
Afifah Kashif, Vy Nguyen, Vinitha Ranganeni
ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2027. [Under Review]

[2] Do Language and Visual Perturbations Compound? Interaction Effects and Backend Sensitivity in Compact Vision-Language-Action Model Evaluation
Abdul Muhsin Hameed, **Afifah Kashif**, Asim Iqbal
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2027. [Under Review]

[3] Refusal Is Not Scored: A Coverage Limit in Content-Based Bias Evaluation
Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek, Jin Huang, Hatice Gunes
Manuscript. [arXiv submission pending]

[4] Synthetic Dataset Creation as Governance Infrastructure for Embodied AI Bias Evaluation
Afifah Kashif
UK AI Research Symposium (UKAIRS) 2026, Emerging Research Track.

[5] Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI
Avijit Ghosh, **Afifah Kashif**, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi
Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio). [Under Review]

[6] Mapping Collective Imaginaries of AI Risk: Expert Elicitation, Causal Modeling and LLM-Assisted Coding
Anshikha Kumar*****, **Afifah Kashif***, Jacob Haimes, Swaptik Chowdhury
AI4GOOD Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026. *Equal contribution

[7] Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human-Robot Interaction
Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek
2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2026.

[8] Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems
Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal
arXiv:2602.01503, 2026. [Preprint]

[9] Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers
Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak
Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2025.

[10] Assessing GPT's Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia
Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel* *Equal contribution
Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Workshop @ ASIS&T US West 2025

Other Writing

The Hidden Social Costs of AI
EvalEval Coalition. Blog Post. November 2025.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Winner, Hack the Law Research Pitch (2026): Stanford x Cambridge competition for funded research placement.

Top 5 Nominee, Academic Representative of the Year (2026): Cambridge Excellence Awards.

Marcy Migdal Fellowship (2025): UW Center for Global Studies; funded a digital literacy program for recently resettled refugee women.

Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute (2025): Inaugural cohort, Stockholm, Sweden.

Distinguished Leader Award (2023): Harvard WECode.

TALKS

Panelist, "Intergenerational Perspectives on AI in a Changing World" Jun 2026
Centre for Human-Inspired AI, Annual Conference, University of Cambridge Union

Dissertation Seminar, "Bias by Whose Definition?" May 2026
Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge

Speaker, CHIA Early Career Community Event May 2026
Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge

Guest Lecture, "An Ethical AI Lens for Neuroinclusive Design" Feb 2026
Inclusive Design Futures (Dr. Matteo Zallio), University of Cambridge

Speaker, "The Politics of Educational Technology" Feb 2026
Clareity × Whiston Series, Clare College 700th Anniversary, University of Cambridge

SERVICE

Program Committee: UserSim: Grounded User Simulation Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026

Workshop Host: CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Conference 2024 (first and only undergraduate team)

Hackathon Organizer: Shared Futures Foundation London Ethics Buildathon, 2026; Techtogether Seattle, 2023

Member: EvalEval Coalition 2025 – Present

AI Research Events Lead: Cambridge AI Research Society 2026 – 2026

Academic Representative: Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity 2025 – 2026

Executive Officer: Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council, University of Washington 2022 – 2024

Co-Founder and Vice President: Women in Law Society, University of Washington 2023 – 2025

TEACHING

Supervisor, Computer Science and Human-Computer Interaction Oct 2025 – Mar 2026
University of Cambridge *Cambridge, UK*

Founder and Instructor, Digital Literacy Program Jan 2025 – Present
International Rescue Committee and Kabul Seattle Community Services *Seattle, WA*

Teaching Assistant, Intro Programming and The Hardware/Software Interface Jan 2023 – Mar 2025
University of Washington *Seattle, WA*

Section Leader, Code in Place Apr 2024 – May 2024
Stanford University *Remote*

Language and Literacy Teacher Jan 2024 – Mar 2024
CPIA1 Roma *Rome, Italy*

LANGUAGES

English (native), Urdu/Hindi (native)